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Open Banking Update: What Canada's Proposed Rules Mean for Financial Institutions

Symcor

JUL 2, 2026



Canada has taken an important step toward implementing consumer-driven banking (open banking).

On June 27, 2026, the federal government published proposed regulations under the [Canada Gazette](#), providing new detail on how financial data sharing will work in practice. While the rules remain open for consultation until August 26, 2026, they offer the clearest view yet of how the framework will be implemented and what it will require from financial institutions.

Key Takeaways

The proposed regulations move open banking from broad policy direction to execution and begin to reshape both the economics and operational realities of participation.

1. The operating model is now clear

The framework establishes a national, regulated ecosystem with:

- Central oversight by the Bank of Canada
- A formal accreditation model; and
- Planned common requirements for security, consent, and data sharing.

This confirms that open banking in Canada will be built on standardized, API-based connectivity.



balances, transactions) at no cost when directed by the customer.

At the same time, derived or enhanced data is excluded, creating a clear distinction between:

- Basic data access (commoditized); and
- Value-added insights and services (differentiated).

This introduces a structural shift:

Core data is becoming table stakes. The competitive advantage moves to how institutions enrich, analyze, and apply that data, and how they turn it into better customer experiences.

3. Competitive pressure accelerates

The framework expands the type of data that can be shared, including:

- Account details.
- Product information such as fees and interest rates.

This makes it easier for customers to compare offerings and adopt alternative services.

The result:

Competition will accelerate across the ecosystem, and customer experience will matter more than ever, shaped by speed, convenience, and value.

4. Participation introduces new operational and liability considerations

The framework establishes a shared liability model, where responsibility sits with the party involved in the step where a failure occurs (e.g. consent, data transfer, access).

For financial institutions, this creates new requirements around:

- Auditability and traceability of data flows;
- Operational controls and compliance processes; and
- Ongoing monitoring and reporting obligations.

Open banking is not just a connectivity challenge – it adds a new layer of operational and risk management complexity.

5. The question is no longer “if,” but “how”



- Enable secure data access;
- Meet evolving standards; and
- Manage ongoing connectivity and compliance

For many, this introduces a practical consideration: how to participate effectively without taking on a full infrastructure build and long-term operational burden.

What This Means for the Industry

The introduction of a shared national framework reduces uncertainty while increasing competitive and operational expectations.

- Core data access becomes standardized, lowering barriers across the ecosystem.
- Differentiation shifts to data usage, customer experience, and product innovation.
- Operational requirements expand, including compliance, monitoring, and risk management.

As a result, institutions must now balance:

- Speed to value;
- Investment in differentiated capabilities; and
- The cost of participation.

Symcor's Perspective

As the framework moves from concept to implementation, the industry is facing a set of shared challenges that extend beyond basic connectivity.

First, the security and standards approach matters.

We continue to recommend **FAPI 2.0** as the baseline for the Canadian ecosystem to reduce friction for new participants and avoid costly rework as standards evolve.

Second, much of the required infrastructure is not a source of competitive differentiation.

Capabilities such as registry integration, accreditation support, consent management, certificate handling, reporting, and monitoring represent a common layer that every participant will need to operate. Building and maintaining these components independently creates duplication and ongoing cost without improving customer outcomes.



recipients. Designing for both roles from the outset allows onboarding, controls, and governance to be established once, rather than duplicated over time.

Finally, the greater risk for the ecosystem is fragmentation, not regulation.

As core data access becomes standardized and competition intensifies, competitive advantage will shift toward customer experience, product innovation, and the effective use of data. A neutral, Canadian infrastructure layer helps reduce fragmentation and operational complexity, allowing institutions to focus scarce engineering capacity on customer-facing differentiation rather than underlying connectivity and compliance requirements.

What's Next

The proposed regulations are open for consultation until **August 26, 2026**. As the regulatory process continues, we are actively reviewing the proposed rules and contributing to the consultation process.

In the interim, financial institutions should assess:

- Where open banking creates near-term business value?
- How data strategy will evolve beyond basic data access?
- How to compete as core data becomes standardized? and
- How to participate without incurring unnecessary infrastructure and operational cost?

Many institutions are already working through these questions, particularly how to balance building capabilities internally versus connecting through a shared approach.

If you're exploring how to approach open banking readiness, we're happy to share how other institutions are thinking about build vs. connect strategies.

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